With Travel as Her Guide

Whether it's an outdoor shoot or a family trip, actress Raveena Tandon knows how to squeeze maximum delight from the itinerary she is given

Q. What is travel for you– recreation or nourishment?
It's strictly for rejuvenation, for me-time. I love exploring new places and, thankfully, my job gives me ample opportunity to travel. Holidays also mean stepping out of my workwear and being myself. It's a refreshing change.

Q. You do travel a lot for work. Is shooting outdoors one of the better perks of your job?
It all depends on the script. I do travel a lot for work. If a situation requires it, I am happy to travel. You get to see the real side of many places, feel and capture some exciting moments. It can be very interesting when I sense a strong connection with places and people. My job demands the best of me and it also offers me some unforgettable moments.

Q. You once said that travel can be an education. Of all the destinations that you and your family have visited in India, which one has afforded the greatest learning?
Travelling is to gather experience, and wisdom comes from experience. We have read about the majesty of the Himalayas, the vastness of the ocean and the beauty of the Taj Mahal, but we get to know much more about them when we see them with our own eyes. Travelling helps the traveller know that this wonderful Earth is full of natural beauty. A lot of places, however, have different vibes. Some places are known for the cuisine, some for their historic culture and some for beautiful scenic sights. I make sure that when I plan a trip, it becomes a wholesome thing for the kids.

Q. How important a role does food play when you're firming up your itinerary?
One way in which we can experience culture is by interacting with its food. Food, as part of culture, is as important as anything else—people, language, art, religion.

Q. You are an avid wildlife photographer. Beyond the thrill of it, is there something else about the experience that you find satisfying?
Of course, the whole experience of discovering something new and unexpected is truly satisfying. As a wildlife photographer, you may sometimes stumble upon something that captivates you for long and that cannot be described in words. The more thirsty you are for such kinds of experiences, the more often they might happen. You need to go ahead, break boundaries and explore to the hilt.

–with Shreevatsa Nevatia

